

Edition does not even offer Internet Connection Sharing and bridging of networks, a feature available in all other variants.

Hosting a Remote Desktop connection is only supported on Professional and Ultimate, however, all Home variants can connect via Remote Desktop. Also, Home variants lack the utility to make files available offline.

1.1.7 Mobility

Home Basic and Starter do not offer Tablet-PC functionality and multi-touch support, something that comes by default in Home Premium, Professional and Ultimate. Also, Windows Mobility Center in Home variants (Home Basic and Home Presentation) lacks presentation mode present in Professional and Ultimate.

1.1.8 Enterprise Features

This is one area where Ultimate scores big above all other variants. Several features such as Applocker, Booting from VHD, DirectAccess, Federated Search, Multilingual User Interface Language Packs, BranchCache and a subsystem for UNIX-based applications are only available for Ultimate and if any of these are essential to you, Windows Ultimate is your only choice. Also, Windows XP mode, Location-Aware Printing and the ability to join a domain or company networks are only available in Professional and Ultimate. Home variants miss out on almost all enterprise features, but nothing surprising about that.



Compatible with Windows 7 logo to be put on devices which have been approved for Windows 7

1.2 Windows 7 vs. Vista vs. XP

Each new software version brings with it a silent promise that it will be better than the last one and most people switch to it instantly. But Windows Vista changed all that. For whatever reasons, be it the vast difference between Vista and XP, popular reluctance to switch or performance issues with Vista that dragged along, it was very poorly received. As a result, computer manufacturers were forced to sell new systems with XP or at least offer a downgrade option. Even as service pack 1 was released adoption was still less than stellar, especially in enterprises, prompting Microsoft to launch